Topic 9: Use of Force

LAWS2000/8015 International Law

1. **Explain the differences between Jus ad bellum and Jus in bello.**

2. In 2024, the XV rebel group in Country A – allegedly supported and armed by Country B – was advancing throughout the country, eventually taking control of Country A's capital.

   In 2025, Country's C petroleum facility was attacked by drones. That facility contains one of the largest petroleum processing plants in the world. The drone attack damaged several stabilisation towers at the plant, which are essential for removing impurities from crude oil. This caused severe disruptions and reduced the supply of refined oil available for export, leading to a surge in global oil prices and significant economic impacts on Asian and European countries that heavily rely on oil from Country C.

   The XV rebel group in Country A claimed responsibility for the attack. Country C also accused Country B of involvement, citing evidence from recovered drone parts and a UN fact-finding report that suggested Country B had supplied the drones. Country B denied any involvement in the attack.

   a. **Would Country C be entitled to use force in self-defence under international law?**

   b. **Would your answer be any different if, instead of an actual drone attack, Country C had obtained satellite evidence showing that Country B was in the process of deploying a large number of troops and short-range ballistic missiles at their shared border?**

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